Indian masses compounded when news broke out about a celebrity singer Kanika Kapoor testing positive for coronavirus after returning from the UK and attending a party in Lucknow. When efforts to contact trace began, one after the other news of politicians and celebrities in attendance at the party isolating and testing themselves took over social media home pages. Former Chief Minister of Rajasthan Vasundhara Raje and her son, Member of Parliament (MP), Dushyant Singh were at the party and had come in contact with the singer. Raje announced that the duo would get tested and go into isolation. But before that, Dushyant had attended a breakfast meeting with the President of India, Ram Nath Kovind along with several other MPs and marked his attendance in the Lok Sabha. All those who came in contact with him including Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Union Minister of Jal Shakti Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, actress Hema Malini, BJP MP Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore, Trinamool Congress MP Derek O'Brien and several others made announcements that they would get tested and isolate themselves as well. The same day, one of the Italian tourists who had tested positive for the virus, passed away in the hospital where he was being treated. Alarm was rapidly spreading.

The MoHFW, in an effort to ensure clear communication, disseminate any panic arising amongst the people as well as to ward off rumours and superstition began to hold daily video briefings outlining the status of the COVID-19 situation in India. They announced that there would be no issues in the supply of essential commodities at any point in time during the lockdown. They also started a COVID-19 helpline number, which would be useful in getting any kind of facts about the virus. They repeatedly assured the people that the measures taken by the government at this point were preventative, so there wouldn't come a time when the virus would get the better of us.

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22 MARCH 2020

INDIA | 364 ACTIVE CASES | 8 DEATHS

WORLD | 314,668 ACTIVE CASES | 14,992 DEATHS

As per the prime minister's orders, the country, in all its essence, followed the junta curfew. People stayed indoors, in the safe haven of their homes.